

Last June, JK Cement acquired a 60% stake in Jammu & Kashmir-based Saifco Cements for ₹150 crore, becoming the first major manufacturer to set up operations in Srinagar.

Singhanian says apart from expansion, growing at the right pace is also essential, because cement is a balance sheet game. “We have to ensure that the net debt-to-Ebitda ratio on the balance sheet remains within two,” he says, adding that care must be taken to ensure that one is not caught by surprise in case of a sudden downcycle if supply outpaces demand.

Singhanian credits the right team and building the JK Super Cement brand for the exceptional performance. He is upbeat about cement demand in the country on the back of massive capex and infrastructure push.

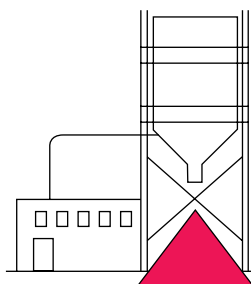
Sustainability is also a key focus for JK Cement and has kept it on the right cost curve. The company has taken steps to use more renewable energy and replace coal and traditional fuel. The initiatives started five to six years ago. Today, renewable sources meet 50-55% power needs. It is also using waste to replace coal or fuel and has about 15% thermal substitution rate. This means 15% of fuel has been replaced by burning waste which otherwise would have gone into a landfill.

Sustainability is an opportunity, says Singhanian, because the more sustainable the company is, the more profitable it becomes. But it is also a challenge due to the very nature of the business. Cement is made through calcination of limestone, which self-produces carbon dioxide.

JK Cement is aiming to reduce emissions by 25% to 470 kilos per tonne by 2030 from about 600 kilos per tonne at present. Singhanian says the company has done quite well so far and brought down emissions by 10-15%. While India aims to become net zero by 2070, Singhanian hopes that more technology interventions will help the company find better solutions.

GROWTH STRATEGY

- 01 **JK Cement is looking to expand capacity and has set a target of reaching 50 mtpa by 2030**
- 02 **The company's focus is on renewable and sustainable energy sources to reduce emissions**
- 03 **It has entered new businesses of paints and construction chemicals**
- 04 **The company focused on putting the right team in place and building on the JK Super Cement brand**



Ashutosh Murarka, Cement Analyst at Choice Institutional Equities, says JK Cement's expansion plan is progressing as scheduled, with total capacity expected to scale up to over 36 million tonnes by FY27 from about 28.7 million tonnes as of December 2025. “This capacity build-out positions the company to capture incremental demand and strengthen its market presence,” he says.

The management continues to demonstrate a sharp focus on cost leadership and sustainability, with green power adoption rising meaningfully to 52% (versus 19% in FY20) and a clear road map to reach 75% by FY30. “This structural shift not only lowers energy costs but also enhances long-term margin resilience,” he says, adding that financial discipline remains a core pillar, with net debt/EBITDA well below 2x, reflecting a prudent capital allocation strategy even amid expansion.

In FY25, the company posted a standalone net profit of ₹872 crore in FY25, up 4.7% up year-on-year from ₹830.64 crore in FY24. Grey cement contributed 81% to its revenue mix and white cement, included value added products, the remaining 19%. JK Cement registered a 9% quarter-on-quarter rise in its consolidated net profit to ₹174 crore in the third quarter of the fiscal. It has estimated a ₹47.8 crore liability from the labour codes. Its consolidated Q3 net profit declined 9% on a year-on-year basis. Ebitda was ₹558 crore.

Apart from being instrumental in the company's capacity expansion projects, he is also a keen athlete and sportsman. Along with Raghavpat, he helped launch JKC Sports to build a sports ecosystem in the country.

With his focus on present expansions and getting a future-ready strategy in place, no wonder Singhanian has been chosen as the winner in the cement category of Pillars of Progress in the BT-PwC India's Best CEOs 2026 list. **BT**

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